CERTAIN-COAST — Letters of Commitment

Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Templates for the organisations to adapt, print on their letterhead and sign. Placeholders are [highlighted].

The NATO SPS call requires a commitment letter from each end-user of a Multi-Year Project. The end-user of CERTAIN-COAST is the Albanian Geological Survey (SHGJSH), which administers the groundwater monitoring network on which the warnings are demonstrated; the Water Resources Management Agency (AMBU) has been asked for a narrower letter (data on water-use permits and staff time in kind, no access to wells). The port and the pipeline landfall are assessed from satellite and public data only, so no letter is needed from their owners. A letter from the institution of the partner-country co-director is required; two further letters are optional.

The letters

	Letter	Signed by	Status	Sent / received
1	End-user: Albanian Geological Survey (SHGJSH)	Shërbimi Gjeologjik Shqiptar (Albanian Geological Survey)	Required	[to send]
2	End-user: Water Resources Management Agency (AMBU), staff time in kind	Agjencia e Menaxhimit të Burimeve Ujore (AMBU)	Requested	[to send]
3	Partner-country Project Director's institution (optional: Qatar University signed the Agreement for Joint Research on 5 November)	Partner-country university or research institute	Optional	[to send]
4	Optional: additional NATO co-director's institution	Institution in a NATO member country	Optional	[to send]
5	Optional: Albanian research partner (data and stations)	Albanian geoscience or seismological institute	Optional	[to send]

How to use these templates

1. Send each template to the organisation named in it, with the project summary (Abstract) and the relevant section of the Partnership document.

2. The organisation adapts the text to what it can really commit to, replaces every yellow placeholder, prints the letter on its own letterhead, and has it signed (and stamped, where usual) by a person authorised to commit it.

3. Do not sign on behalf of an organisation and do not send unsigned letters as if they were signed; reviewers check that commitments are genuine.

4. Collect the signed letters as PDF and merge them into one file: the platform (tab 9, End-Users) takes a single PDF with all end-user commitments; keep the originals.

5. What the call asks (2027-1): "an end-user commitment letter for each of the project's end-users"; for governmental end-users the form accepts a letter of support from the ministry or agency. Letters go to NATO in English; an Albanian reading copy of the letters of the Albanian organisations is in CERTAIN-COAST_Letters_of_Commitment_SQ.docx.

What makes these letters strong

• **Specific and checkable.** Each letter states what the organisation will provide and when, using the months of the Work Plan (access by Month 3, thresholds in Months 13–15, live operation in Months 23–34), so reviewers can see a real plan rather than general support.

• **Security conditions stated up front.** Each end-user letter sets the rules for access and data (restricted tier, review of publications), consistent with the Data Management Plan.

• **Responsibilities clear.** The letters say that the bulletins are advisory, that decisions remain with the users, and that public warnings remain with the authorities.

• **Looking beyond the project.** End-users state their intention to use the system, adopt procedures and discuss its maintenance after the project, which supports the Sustainability plan.

[Template 1 of 5: End-user: Albanian Geological Survey (SHGJSH). Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF SHËRBIMI GJEOLOGJIK SHQIPTAR (ALBANIAN GEOLOGICAL SURVEY)]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (groundwater monitoring network and geological hazards), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Shërbimi Gjeologjik Shqiptar (Albanian Geological Survey) administers the groundwater monitoring network of Albania and produces its data, and works on the geological hazards of the country. The coastal plain from Durrës to Fushë Kuqe, with its aquifers, soft sediments, subsidence and active faults, is a priority for our work. We support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to existing monitoring wells of our network on the Durrës–Fushë Kuqe coast for the project's level, conductivity, temperature and barometric loggers, bought by the project and installed together with our staff, from Month [4];
- the groundwater-level and chemistry records of our network and [geological and hydrogeological maps and borehole logs] for the coastal plain, under a data access agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- staff time of [2] experts, about [10] working days a year, as an in-kind contribution: for the siting and installation of the sensors (Months 1–12), the agreement of the warning thresholds (Months 13–15) and the review of the bulletins during the live operation (Months 23–34);
- participation of [number] staff in the workshops and in the training on the open software (Months 24–36).

We intend to receive and use the certified groundwater and geological-hazard bulletins for the coastal plain during the live operation (Months 23–34), to use the open software and the monitoring design in our groundwater monitoring network, and to consider keeping the project's sensors in our network after the project.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Shërbimi Gjeologjik Shqiptar (Albanian Geological Survey)

[Template 2 of 5: End-user: Water Resources Management Agency (AMBU), staff time in kind. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF AGJENCIA E MENAXHIMIT TË BURIMEVE UJORE (AMBU)]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (water resources), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Agjencia e Menaxhimit të Burimeve Ujore (AMBU, Water Resources Management Agency) manages the water resources of Albania, including the Tiranë–Fushë Kuqe–Lezhë aquifer that supplies Durrës. Seawater intrusion, record droughts and land subsidence threaten this aquifer. We support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- the data that we hold on water-use permits and abstraction for the Tiranë–Fushë Kuqe–Lezhë aquifer, under a data access agreement to be signed by Month 3; the groundwater-level and chemistry records of the national monitoring network, and access to its wells, are arranged with the Albanian Geological Survey, which administers that network;
- staff time of [2] experts, about [5] working days a year, as an in-kind contribution: to agree the chloride warning threshold and the acceptable false-alarm rate (Months 13–15) and to review the pumping and drought rule against the water-use permits (Months 24–33);
- participation of [2] staff in the workshops and in the training on the open software (Months 24–36).

We intend to use the chloride early warning for each supply well and the pumping and drought rule in [our monitoring programme and water-use permits for this aquifer], and to consider applying the method to other aquifers of Albania. Our contribution is staff time in kind; it creates no financial obligation and no obligations of procurement, ownership or maintenance for AMBU.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Agjencia e Menaxhimit të Burimeve Ujore (AMBU)

[Template 3 of 5: Partner-country Project Director's institution (optional: Qatar University signed the Agreement for Joint Research on 5 November). Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF PARTNER-COUNTRY UNIVERSITY OR RESEARCH INSTITUTE]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, partner-country co-director, for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

[Partner-country university or research institute], in [eligible partner country], commits to take part in CERTAIN-COAST as the institution of the partner-country Project Director, [title and name], who is employed by us in [eligible partner country].

In particular, we will provide:

- leadership of training, transfer and dissemination (WP6): two-month exchanges of our early-career researchers on the Durrës coast, a regional workshop and the open release of the results;
- a transfer study of the method on a coast of [eligible partner country], carried out with the project's tools and the Albanian team, using open satellite data and available records;
- a user-side review of the bulletins and operating procedures;
- the salaries of our staff and the use of our facilities and computing, as an in-kind contribution;
- participation of [number] early-career researchers in the project.

We accept the terms of the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project Handbook and of the award, will sign the SPS MYP Agreement for Joint Research and the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement, and will follow the project's data management plan, ethics measures and two-tier dissemination rules.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
[Partner-country university or research institute]

[Template 4 of 5: Optional: additional NATO co-director's institution. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF INSTITUTION IN A NATO MEMBER COUNTRY]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, additional NATO co-director, for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

[Institution in a NATO member country], in [NATO member country], commits to take part in CERTAIN-COAST as the institution of an additional co-director, [title and name].

In particular, we will provide:

- expertise and supervision for InSAR time-series processing (WP1) and for seismic velocity monitoring with ambient noise (T4.4);
- the salaries of our staff and the use of our facilities, as an in-kind contribution;
- hosting of early-career researchers for training visits.

We accept the terms of the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project Handbook and of the award, will sign the SPS MYP Agreement for Joint Research and the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement, and will follow the project's data management plan, ethics measures and dissemination rules.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
[Institution in a NATO member country]

[Template 5 of 5: Optional: Albanian research partner (data and stations). Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF ALBANIAN GEOSCIENCE OR SEISMOLOGICAL INSTITUTE]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, research partner, for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

[Albanian geoscience or seismological institute] supports the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commits to take part as a research partner.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to data from our [seismic, strong-motion and GNSS stations / hydrological and meteorological stations] on the Durrës coast under a data agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- technical support for the installation and upkeep of the project's seismic and GNSS stations;
- participation in the post-event protocol after strong earthquakes or storms.

We intend to continue supporting the geodetic and seismic stations after the project, as foreseen in the sustainability plan, and will follow the project's data management plan and dissemination rules.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
[Albanian geoscience or seismological institute]